AI Management Framework (AIMF) by PraeSyn

Frequently Asked Questions (FAQ)

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Getting Started

What is the AI Management Framework (AIMF)?

AIMF is a comprehensive, standards-based framework for assessing, developing, and improving organizational AI governance capabilities. It provides:

- 72 controls aligned with ISO 42001 and NIST AI RMF
- 5 maturity levels (Initial → Optimizing) across 4 capability dimensions
- 3 implementation tiers (B1, B2, B3) based on risk levels
- 6 framework profiles for different organizational contexts
- Complete standards integration (ISO 42001, NIST AI RMF, ISO 27001, Executive Orders)

Key Differentiators:

- **Practical implementation**: Tier-specific requirements with clear acceptance criteria
- **Profile-based approach**: Customizable starting points for different organizations and industries
- **Maturity progression**: Clear pathways from initial AI governance to optimized programs
- **Open framework**: Free to use under CC BY-NC-ND 4.0 license

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How does AIMF relate to other frameworks?

AIMF is designed as a **practical implementation guide** for existing standards:

Standard	Relationship
ISO 42001	AIMF maps all 72 controls to ISO 42001 clauses; can be used for ISO 42001 certification preparation
NIST AI RMF	AIMF's 4 functions (GOVERN, MAP, MEASURE, MANAGE) align with NIST AI RMF; all 59 NIST subcategories mapped
ISO 27001	AIMF security controls map to ISO 27001 Annex A; complementary for AI + cybersecurity governance
Executive Orders 14110/14179	AIMF profiles address EO requirements for federal agencies and AI safety reporting
EU AI Act	High-Assurance profile supports high-risk AI requirements; compliance mappings in development

Think of it this way: NIST AI RMF and ISO 42001 define "what" (requirements), AIMF defines "how" (implementation with tiers, profiles, and maturity progression).

Is AIMF suitable for my organization?

AIMF is flexible and scalable to organizations of all sizes and AI maturity levels:

Organization Type	Recommended Starting Point
Small business with low-risk AI	Foundational Profile (35 controls at B1)
Mid-market SaaS company	Balanced Profile (50 controls at B2)
Regulated financial institution	Financial Services Profile (59 controls at B2-B3)
Healthcare provider	Healthcare Profile (62 controls at B2-B3)
Government agency	Government Profile (63 controls at B2-B3)
High-risk AI (autonomous systems)	High-Assurance Profile (72 controls at B3)

Key Question: Do you develop, deploy, or use AI systems? If yes, AIMF can help establish appropriate governance.

Framework Concepts

What's the difference between maturity levels, tiers, and profiles?

These are three complementary dimensions of AIMF:

Maturity Levels (1-5): **WHERE you are**

- Assess organizational capability: Initial → Developing → Defined → Managed → Optimizing
- Applied across 4 dimensions: Governance, Data, Technical, Culture
- **Use**: Self-assessment to understand current state and set improvement targets

Risk Baselines (B1, B2, B3): **HOW rigorously you implement**

- B1 (Initial): Basic implementation for low-risk AI
- B2 (Mature): Systematic implementation for moderate-risk AI
- B3 (High-Risk): Maximum rigor for high-risk/critical AI
- **Use**: Select appropriate implementation depth based on AI system risk

Profiles: **WHICH controls you implement**

- Framework profiles: Pre-defined control selections (Foundational, Balanced, Healthcare, etc.)
- Implementation profiles: Your organization's customized control selection
- **Use**: Tailor AIMF to your industry, risk profile, and regulatory requirements

Example: A mid-market healthcare company might use the Healthcare Profile (which controls), implement at B2 tier (how rigorous), and currently be at Maturity Level 2 (where they are), targeting Level 3 (where they want to be).

How many controls do I need to implement?

This depends on your profile selection and risk assessment:

Profile	Controls	Coverage	Typical Use Case
Foundational	35	48%	Minimum viable governance; low-risk AI
Balanced	50	68%	Standard enterprise AI governance
High-Assurance	72	100%	Maximum rigor for high-risk AI
Financial Services	59	81%	Regulated financial institutions
Healthcare	62	85%	Patient-facing and clinical AI
Government	63	86%	Public sector with transparency requirements

You can customize: Start with a framework profile, then add/remove controls based on your specific context. Document deviations with risk acceptance decisions.

Recommendation: Start with Foundational (establish basics), advance to Balanced (comprehensive program), then consider High-Assurance or industry profiles as needed.

Can I implement AIMF incrementally?

Yes! AIMF is designed for phased implementation:

Typical Phased Approach:

1. **Phase 1 (Months 1-3)**: Governance Foundation
   - Establish AI governance committee
   - Document legal/regulatory requirements
   - Conduct initial AI system inventory and risk assessment
   - Implement essential GOVERN controls
2. **Phase 2 (Months 3-9)**: Comprehensive Assessment
   - Impact assessments for AI systems
   - Testing and validation procedures (MEASURE controls)
   - Stakeholder engagement program
   - Initial monitoring capabilities
3. **Phase 3 (Months 9-18)**: Operational Excellence
   - Continuous monitoring and improvement (MANAGE controls)
   - Incident response integration
   - Training and capability development

- Regular audits and reviews

Start small, prove value, expand: Focus on high-priority controls or high-risk AI systems first, then expand coverage.

Implementation Questions

Do I need to hire a consultant to implement AIMF?

Not required, but may accelerate implementation:

Self-Implementation (Internal team only):

- **Advantages**: Lower cost, builds internal capability, full control
- **Best for**: Organizations with existing governance/compliance expertise, mature risk management programs
- **Timeline**: 9-18 months for Balanced Profile (longer for High-Assurance)
- **Resources**: Dedicated 2-4 FTE team (governance lead, compliance, technical)

Consultant-Assisted:

- **Advantages**: Faster implementation, expert guidance, external validation
- **Best for**: Organizations new to AI governance, complex regulatory requirements, limited internal expertise
- **Timeline**: 6-12 months with external support for Balanced Profile
- **Cost**: $50K-300K depending on scope and consultant (ballpark estimates)

Hybrid Approach (Recommended):

- External consultant for Phase 1 (governance design, framework customization)
- Internal team for Phases 2-3 (implementation, ongoing management)
- External audit/validation at completion

How long does AIMF implementation take?

Implementation timelines vary by profile, organization size, and existing maturity:

Profile	Timeline	Assumptions
Foundational	3-6 months	Small org, low-risk AI, dedicated 1-2 FTE
Balanced	6-12 months	Mid-market to enterprise, moderate-risk, 2-4 FTE
High-Assurance	12-24 months	High-risk AI, dedicated team, external experts
Industry Profiles	9-18 months	Regulatory compliance driver, 3-5 FTE

Factors affecting timeline:

- Existing maturity (higher starting maturity = faster)
- Organizational complexity (multiple business units, geographies)
- Number/complexity of AI systems
- Regulatory requirements (e.g., FDA approval for medical devices)
- Resource availability (dedicated vs part-time team)

Accelerators: Executive commitment, existing compliance programs (SOC 2, ISO 27001), mature MLOps practices, external consultants

Common pitfall: Underestimating stakeholder engagement and change management time

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What roles do I need for AIMF implementation?

Typical implementation team structure:

Core Team (Dedicated):

- **AI Governance Lead** (1 FTE): Overall program management, stakeholder coordination
- **Compliance/Legal** (0.5-1 FTE): Regulatory interpretation, policy development
- **Technical Lead** (1 FTE): MLOps integration, technical controls implementation
- **Quality/Risk** (0.5 FTE): Risk assessment, incident response, audits

Extended Team (Part-time/Advisory):

- **Executive Sponsor**: Budget approval, policy sign-off, organizational influence
- **Data Science/ML Engineers**: Model validation, fairness testing, technical input
- **IT/Security**: Infrastructure security, access controls, monitoring
- **Product Management**: Requirements, impact assessment, stakeholder feedback

- **Legal Counsel**: Contracts, liability, regulatory compliance
- **External Consultants** (optional): Framework design, industry expertise, validation

Governance Committee (Oversight):

- Cross-functional committee meeting monthly/quarterly
- Includes representatives from engineering, legal, product, security, risk
- Reviews AI governance decisions, risk acceptance, policy updates

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Technical Questions

How does AIMF address generative AI (LLMs)?

Generative AI introduces unique risks addressed across AIMF controls:

Key Control Areas:

1. **Safety (MEA-2.6)**: Prompt injection, jailbreaks, harmful content generation
2. **Security (MEA-2.7)**: Model extraction, data poisoning, adversarial attacks
3. **Privacy (MEA-2.10)**: Training data memorization, personal information leakage
4. **Fairness (MEA-2.11)**: Bias amplification in generated content
5. **Transparency (MEA-2.8)**: Disclosure of AI-generated content
6. **Third-Party (MAP-4.1, MAN-3.1)**: Foundation model risks, API dependencies

B3 Requirements for High-Risk Generative AI:

- Red team security testing
- Adversarial robustness evaluation
- Content filtering and safety mechanisms
- User disclosures about AI generation
- Continuous monitoring for misuse patterns

Future: AIMF v1.1 will include a Generative AI use-case profile with expanded guidance.

Does AIMF cover data privacy (GDPR, HIPAA)?

Yes, through MEA-2.10 (Privacy Evaluation) and related controls:

Privacy Controls:

- **MEA-2.10**: Privacy impact assessment, data minimization, consent management
- **MAP-1.3**: Data governance policies aligned with privacy regulations
- **MEA-2.7**: Security safeguards (encryption, access controls)
- **GOV-1.1**: Legal compliance including GDPR, HIPAA, CCPA
- **MAP-3.3**: Data retention and deletion procedures

Healthcare Profile (HIPAA):

- Enhanced MEA-2.10 requirements for PHI-processing AI
- HIPAA Privacy Rule and Security Rule compliance
- Business Associate Agreements for AI vendors
- Breach notification procedures

Government Profile (Privacy Act, FOIA):

- Transparency requirements for data use
- Public access to AI decision logic
- Civil rights protections

Note: AIMF provides AI-specific privacy controls; should complement existing privacy management programs, not replace them.

How does AIMF handle third-party AI (vendors, open-source models)?

Third-party AI requires specialized controls:

MAP Function (Assessment):

- **MAP-4.1**: Third-Party AI Dependency Assessment
  - Evaluate vendor AI governance maturity
  - Assess model transparency and documentation
  - Identify lock-in risks and concentration
- **MAP-4.2**: FOSS AI Risk Management
  - Open-source model provenance and licensing
  - Community governance and support assessment

MANAGE Function (Ongoing Monitoring):

- **MAN-3.1**: Third-Party AI Monitoring
  - Continuous vendor performance tracking
  - Model update notifications and validation
  - Vendor audit rights and reviews
- **MAN-3.2**: Pre-trained Model Management
  - Foundation model lifecycle management
  - Fine-tuning governance
  - Drift detection for vendor models

Contractual Safeguards:

- AI-specific SLAs (performance, fairness, availability)
- Model documentation and explainability requirements
- Audit and validation rights
- Data usage and retention provisions
- Liability and indemnification for AI failures

Risk Tiers:

- B1: Basic vendor assessment, standard contracts
- B2: Documented vendor risk management, audit rights
- B3: Independent vendor validation, continuous monitoring, contractual audit enforcement

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Compliance and Certification

Can AIMF help with ISO 42001 certification?

Yes, AIMF is explicitly designed to support ISO 42001 certification:

Direct Alignment:

- All 72 AIMF controls map to ISO 42001 clauses
- Control catalog includes ISO 42001 clause references
- AIMF Assessment Guide can serve as ISO 42001 internal audit procedure

Using AIMF for ISO 42001 Certification:

1. **Gap Analysis**: Use AIMF maturity assessment to identify ISO 42001 gaps
2. **Implementation**: Use AIMF controls and tier requirements as ISO 42001 implementation guide
3. **Documentation**: AIMF control evidence serves as ISO 42001 documentation
4. **Internal Audit**: AIMF assessment methodology for ISO 42001 compliance audits
5. **Certification Audit**: Present AIMF implementation profile as evidence of ISO 42001 compliance

Balanced Profile = ISO 42001 Core Requirements:

- Balanced Profile (50 controls at B2) covers essential ISO 42001 clauses
- High-Assurance Profile (72 controls at B3) addresses all optional/recommended ISO 42001 controls

Certification Readiness: Organizations implementing AIMF Balanced or High-Assurance profiles should be well-positioned for ISO 42001 certification audit.

Does implementing AIMF guarantee regulatory compliance?

No, but it significantly supports compliance efforts:

What AIMF Provides:

- ✅ Comprehensive control framework aligned with regulatory expectations
- ✅ Standards integration (ISO 42001, NIST AI RMF, ISO 27001)
- ✅ Industry profiles addressing sector-specific regulations
- ✅ Documentation and evidence for compliance audits

What AIMF Does Not Provide:

- ❌ Legal advice or regulatory interpretation
- ❌ Guarantee of compliance with evolving regulations
- ❌ Replacement for legal counsel or compliance officers
- ❌ Automatic approval from regulators

Recommended Approach:

1. Use AIMF to establish AI governance structure
2. Engage legal counsel to interpret specific regulatory requirements
3. Map regulations to AIMF controls (many mappings provided)
4. Implement controls at appropriate tier based on regulatory risk

5. Document compliance evidence through AIMF implementation
6. Engage with regulators proactively to demonstrate governance maturity

Regulatory Confidence: Organizations implementing AIMF can demonstrate systematic AI risk management to regulators, auditors, and stakeholders.

Troubleshooting

Our organization is stuck at Maturity Level 2. How do we advance?

Common challenges advancing from Level 2 (Developing) to Level 3 (Defined):

Typical Blockers:

1. **Ad-hoc processes**: Governance exists but not formalized or consistently applied
   - **Solution**: Document processes, create templates, establish systematic procedures
2. **Limited resources**: Part-time governance team, competing priorities
   - **Solution**: Secure dedicated FTE, demonstrate value through quick wins, phase implementation
3. **Resistance to process**: Engineers view governance as bureaucracy
   - **Solution**: Automate controls, integrate with existing workflows, show efficiency gains
4. **Lack of executive support**: Governance seen as IT problem, not strategic priority
   - **Solution**: Frame AI risk in business terms, demonstrate regulatory/reputational risks, benchmark competitors

Level 2 → Level 3 Transition Guide: See `TIER-2-TO-3-GUIDE.md` for detailed roadmap

Key Success Factors:

- Executive sponsorship (not just budget, but active engagement)
- Integration with existing programs (risk management, compliance, quality)
- Metrics demonstrating governance value (incidents prevented, efficiency gains, compliance readiness)
- Cultural change management (not just policy, but behavior change)

How do I handle conflicts between different fairness metrics?

Fairness metrics often conflict - optimizing for one can worsen another. AIMF addresses this through:

MEA-2.11 (Fairness Assessment) Guidance:

1. **Stakeholder Engagement (MAP-5.2)**: Identify which fairness criteria matter to affected communities
2. **Context-Specific Selection**: Choose fairness metrics appropriate to use case:
   - **Lending**: Equal opportunity (equal true positive rates across groups)
   - **Hiring**: Demographic parity (equal positive rates across groups)
   - **Healthcare**: Calibration (predicted risk = actual risk for all groups)
3. **Multi-Metric Evaluation**: Report multiple fairness metrics, acknowledge tradeoffs
4. **Explainability (MEA-2.9)**: Explain fairness choices to stakeholders
5. **Continuous Monitoring**: Track fairness metrics in production, reassess periodically

B3 Requirement: Independent fairness assessment with stakeholder validation of metric selection

No Universal Answer: Fairness is context-dependent and requires value judgments, not just technical optimization. AIMF ensures these decisions are made transparently with stakeholder input.

Our vendor won't provide model documentation. What do we do?

Common challenge addressed by MAP-4.1 (Third-Party AI Assessment) and MAN-3.1 (Ongoing Monitoring):

Options:

1. **Contract Negotiation**: Include AI documentation requirements in contracts
   - Model cards, training data provenance, performance metrics
   - Audit rights for high-risk AI
   - Notification of model updates with validation data
2. **Risk Acceptance**: If vendor won't provide documentation, document residual risk
   - Require executive risk acceptance
   - Implement compensating controls (additional validation, human oversight)
   - Consider alternative vendors for future
3. **Black-Box Validation**: Test vendor AI as a black box

    - Input/output testing across diverse scenarios
    - Fairness testing with representative data
    - Performance monitoring in production
    - Behavioral testing for edge cases
4. **Regulatory Escalation**: For high-risk AI in regulated industries, consider:
    - Engaging regulator for guidance on undocumented vendor AI
    - Declining to use vendor AI if documentation insufficient for compliance
    - Seeking alternative vendors with better transparency

B2/B3 Requirement: Vendor AI used in moderate/high-risk applications must have sufficient documentation for validation. If vendor refuses, escalate or accept documented risk.

Future of AIMF

Will AIMF be updated? How often?

Yes, AIMF will evolve with AI technology and regulation:

Version Strategy:

- **v1.x (Minor Updates)**: Every 6-12 months
    - Add new framework profiles (e.g., Generative AI, Manufacturing, Energy)
    - Refine control guidance based on implementation feedback
    - Update regulatory mappings (EU AI Act, state laws)
- **v2.x (Major Updates)**: Every 2-3 years
    - Incorporate new standards (ISO revisions, NIST updates)
    - Restructure controls if needed based on industry evolution
    - Add new capability dimensions or maturity levels if warranted

Compatibility: Minor updates (v1.x) maintain backward compatibility. Organizations on v1.0 can upgrade to v1.1 without major rework.

Community Input: PraeSyn welcomes feedback on AIMF through [feedback channels TBD].

What's coming in AIMF v1.1?

Planned enhancements (target: Q3 2026):

New Framework Profiles:

- **Generative AI Profile**: Specific to LLMs and gen AI risks
- **Manufacturing/Industrial AI Profile**: OT, safety, automation
- **Small Business Profile**: Simplified (25 controls) for resource-constrained organizations

Enhanced Guidance:

- Generative AI control guidance across all functions
- EU AI Act compliance mapping
- State AI law compliance (Colorado, California, etc.)

Tooling (Proprietary):

- Interactive assessment tool
- Gap analysis and roadmap generator
- Control evidence repository templates

Community Profiles: Selected user-contributed implementation profiles with permission

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How can I contribute to AIMF?

AIMF is an open framework with opportunities for community engagement:

Open Framework (No Contribution Needed):

- Use AIMF freely under CC BY-NC-ND 4.0 license
- Create implementation profiles for your organization
- Share learnings with community (encouraged but not required)

Feedback and Suggestions:

- Report issues, suggest improvements [channels TBD]
- Share implementation experiences and lessons learned

Professional Services (Proprietary):

- PraeSyn offers consulting for AIMF implementation
- Custom framework profiles for unique industries
- Training and certification programs

Attribution: If you reference AIMF publicly (case studies, presentations), please credit "AI Management Framework (AIMF) by PraeSyn"

Contact and Support

Where can I get help implementing AIMF?

Self-Service Resources:

- [AIMF GitHub Repository] (TBD): Complete documentation, examples, templates
- AIMF Profiles Guide: Profile selection methodology
- Implementation Tier Guide: Tier requirements
- Tier Transition Guides: Maturity advancement roadmaps

Professional Services:

- PraeSyn Consulting: [Contact information TBD]
  - AIMF implementation consulting
  - Custom profile development
  - Assessment and gap analysis
  - Training programs

Community (Future):

- [AIMF Community Forum] (TBD): Peer support, implementation discussions
- [Case Studies] (TBD): Learn from other organizations' AIMF implementations

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How do I report an issue or suggest an improvement?

Issue Reporting [Channels TBD]:

- GitHub Issues (for documentation errors, clarifications)
- Email: [support email TBD]

When Reporting Issues, Include:

- AIMF version (v1.0)
- Document reference (e.g., "AIMF-CONTROL-CATALOG.md, Control GOV-1.1")
- Issue description (what's wrong or unclear)
- Suggested fix (if applicable)

Response Time: PraeSyn will review submitted issues; response times vary based on severity and volume.

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This FAQ will be updated regularly. Last updated: January 25, 2026 (v1.0 release)

For additional questions not covered here, consult the comprehensive framework documentation or contact PraeSyn professional services.